



rotation and include variety in our diet. Instead of getting obsessed with one [kind of] food because there are stories about it, it is better to follow the route of moderation and variety,” she suggests.

So the general consensus is that at the end of the day what is important is a healthy diet and superfoods can be incorporated in that. Also, not all superfoods are imported or need to burn a hole in your pocket. So while a kale salad with added chia seeds and blueberries is great, there are several ingredients in your kitchen that have superfood qualities. “Things such as turmeric, garlic and a leaf like curry *patta* (leaves) can be a part of your daily diet,” says Devgan. Turmeric is a superfood because it has curcumin, a natural antioxidant. Similarly, garlic provides alliin which is very good for immunity. Curry leaves are an excellent source of fibre and packed with antioxidants. *Shakarkandi* (sweet potato) has more vitamin A than kale and *jamun* and *falsa* when in season can be had in place of blueberries. Chia seeds too can be replaced with *sabja* (a kind of basil) seeds, says Devgan. Quinoa (another popularly marketed superfood) can be replaced with any of the millets as they have similar protein content. Devgan also recommends oats as they are high in soluble fibre beta-glucan which is good for lowering cholesterol.

Moringa (drumsticks) is one of the most power-packed foods around with nearly 13 vitamins

and several minerals. Mangoes are rich in vitamin A, iron and fibre which is good for your gut.

Sayed says just looking around the kitchen, one spots foods that are wasted but full of nutrients. For instance, mango peels and watermelon rinds have nutrients that can prevent different metabolic conditions. However, he warns that nothing in excess is good. For instance, caffeine is a superfood as long as you have 1-2 cups a day but if your daily consumption exceeds 600-700

mg, it harms you as caffeine is acidic in nature. He recommends foods rich in Omega 3 such as walnuts, flax seeds and salmon. And those with a high protein content such as eggs, fish, paneer, tofu and soya.

Sharma also advocates a healthy, balanced and clean diet (without preservatives and artificial colours) as the road to health. “We are not eating enough variety. Nearly 80 per cent of our plate is coming from wheat, rice or dairy.”

She recommends incorporating a variety of grains like ragi, jowar, bajra and more green leafy vegetables on a regular basis. She also recommends local superfoods like *buransh* (rhododendron) found in the hills. The flower has fantastic healing properties for the heart. It can be had as a beverage. Also sea buckthorn that grows in the mountains has amazing regenerative properties.

So eat healthy to stay healthy. **BT**

There are several superfoods in our kitchen such as turmeric, garlic, curry leaves, amla and tulsi

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